

James Basler, CTS, CSM

New York, NY

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RECENT EXPERIENCE:

Product Management Consultant

January 2020 - Present, New York, NY

Vivoh - Lead Product Consultant for Enterprise Video Streaming applications

- Driving the product roadmap, ensuring gathered requirements from customer engagements and customer feedback appropriately guide tactical and strategic vision for product features and functionalities.
- Managing the product backlog and maintaining the product scope throughout the product lifecycle and collaborating with the development team to identify “minimally viable product” (MVP) to facilitate effective and efficient product releases.
- Leveraging enterprise video engineering experience to understand and manage trade-offs, ensuring development team, business management, and product stakeholders are informed and aligned on product decisions.

Morgan Stanley - Vice President, Lead of Global Multimedia Engineering

June 2017 - January 2020, New York, NY

Key Responsibilities

- Managed Global Multimedia Engineering Team of video conferencing and video streaming engineers located in NYC & Budapest.
- Acted as Product Owner, Scrum Master, and/or Product Manager for all video conferencing and video streaming products.
- Managed POC, development, and engineering relationships with vendors, including but not limited to Cisco, Vbrick, Crestron, Qumu, Pexip, Zoom, and Logitech. And researched and presented cutting edge video technologies impact and improve the vision and goals for each product space and their roadmap at the firm.
- Collaborated with vendors to conceive of and develop feature enhancements and better prioritize their product roadmaps to meet the firm's requirements, improve end user experiences, and/or resolve non security related bugs or feature gaps.
- Engaged directly with end users one on one, via focus groups, and/or feedback forms/emails to capture user experiences with video technologies, both in office (at the desk, and in huddle/conference rooms), and remote/WFH, to ensure their needs were appropriately shaping the vision and goals for product roadmaps.
- Participated as lead technical SME in MSA negotiations for new video products. And participated in annual budgeting and contract renewal negotiations with implemented products' vendors/partners.
- Facilitated and coordinated cross-functional multimedia engineering projects using Scrum, primarily via Jira and Kanban as project management and tracking tools. Collaborated with support and communications teams to drive effective product adoption and ensure efficient product releases/rollouts according to established timelines.
- Led weekly and monthly meetings with global end user technology stakeholders, coordinating change management, presenting project status and product roadmaps, ensuring alignment, and capturing feedback from end user partners from different divisions and departments across all regions globally (NA, EMEA, APAC and Japan).
- Collaborated with operations and engineering teams from various technology departments, including networking, proxy, storage, browser, web, QA, LDAP, core infrastructure, and security, to ensure timely/effective implementation of video products
- Responsible for working with the technology risk department, as IT product owner, for security review of all video conferencing and video streaming products, and in turn coordinating remediation/resolution of any discovered vulnerabilities, whether via internal configuration changes or working with the vendor to update associated products.
- Managed all video conferencing and video streaming software and hardware product development lifecycles, whether internally developed, vendor developed, or open source.

Major Projects

- Oversaw the complex process to decommission the firm's legacy video streaming platform and in turn the successful implementation of a modern replacement platform with the application layer and storage in the cloud, and with hybrid media delivery, primarily on premises, for on demand and live (multicast and unicast) streaming for 85,000 global employees.
- Supervised the process to test, certify and implement modern Cisco Collaboration Endpoints into the firm's global video conferencing endpoint catalogue. And oversaw migration/upgrade of global video conferencing infrastructure from legacy Cisco VCS Control and Expressway systems to current Cisco Expressway Core and Edge systems.
- Created performance dashboards and alerting via Splunk for firmwide internal video streaming application, to allow for proactive monitoring and support from the Level 2 and Level 3 operations teams, and use for in-depth data analysis by engineering.
- Directed creation of updated documentation and training for operating video streaming and video conferencing products for Global AV Meeting/Event Operations teams, as well as troubleshooting and deployment documentation for Global Level 2 and Level 3 operations teams supporting associated infrastructure. And developed extensive documentation for driving end user adoption and improving the end user's experience using new video conferencing and video streaming platforms

IAC - Senior Video Conferencing Engineer and Designer

September 2012 - June 2017, New York, NY

Key Responsibilities

- Served as leader and global resource for IAC's 30+ businesses and their corporate offices for projects requiring sourcing and installation/integration of new audiovisual/video conferencing equipment or services.
- Researched, tested, presented, and advocated for new AV and VC equipment/technologies for future implementation at IAC, including attending and presenting at industry trade shows and conferences.
- Provided training, created documentation and developed resources for IAC and its businesses' IT support to better troubleshoot and solve AV and VC issues.
- Coordinated, managed, and assisted integrators in all installations and maintenance of IAC's NYC conference rooms and lobby, including but not limited to Crestron, Extron, Clearone, BiAmp, Prysm, and Christie products.
- Locally and remotely coordinated and managed all audiovisual and video conference setups for the office of the chairman, IAC's NYC based and visiting executives, including but not limited to IAC and Match Group Earnings Calls, and Board of Directors meetings for IAC, Match Group, Expedia Inc., and Coca Cola.
- Collaborated daily with IAC Networking, Systems, and IT teams to ensure firmwide video conferencing quality and stability.

Major Projects

- Led process to create and define global video conferencing standards and practices for all of IAC's businesses and its 5,000 employees, where previously, standardization across the various businesses' locations/offices did not exist.
- Acted as AV and video conferencing SME during the build out of Tinder's new offices in LA, working closely with Tinder IT and the project's AV integrator.
- Oversaw transition of IAC's video bridging services from BlueJeans to Ubiety, a cloud hosted CMS as a service, which resulted in a 70% year-over-year cost reduction, while doubling user adoption and usage rates of the previous service.
- Directed extensive AV and VC upgrades to IAC's board room with a \$380K project budget.
- Created new UX and UI for Crestron touch panel programming for the headquarters conference room upgrade projects.
- Designed new digital signage interface for the IAC lobby video wall using the Barco X2O media system. Oversaw and managed the content and operation of the X2O digital signage platform.

EDUCATION:

University of South Carolina, Columbia, SC

BA - Media Arts (Film & Video Production) 2008

GPA 3.9, Magna Cum Laude

RECENT INDUSTRY CERTIFICATIONS AND ENGAGEMENTS:

- Scrum Alliance CSM - Certified ScrumMaster
- Avixa CTS - Certified Technology Specialist
- AV/IT Leadership Summit 2018, Panelist - Session: "Lifecycle Planning for a Softer AV Ecosystem"
- Yamaha Enterprise Customer Advisory Board, 2017
- AV/IT Leadership Summit 2016, Keynote Speaker and Panelist - Keynote: "The Future of Video Now"
- Infocomm 2016, Panelist - Session: "State of UCC Lunch and Learn: End Users Speak Their Minds"

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE:

Alliance Bernstein - Audio Visual Consultant

May 2011 - September 2012, New York, NY

- Scheduled and coordinated daily AV and VC needs for reservations in 60+ conference rooms at company headquarters through a virtual EMS, and by liaising with internal and external clients.
- Oversaw the on-site upgrade of AV hardware and software by integrators for NYC conference rooms.
- Established and managed domestic and international video and audio conference connections both locally and remotely, using TMS, Codian, Crestron and AMX systems, Polycom Video Codecs, and MS LiveMeeting.
- Setup AV equipment and presentation media, and provided dedicated support for the events and meetings of all NYC based AB departments, executives and clients.
- Educated and trained users to be capable of self service conferencing setups and troubleshooting common meeting issues.
- Worked with content management systems and edited recorded video and audio content for internal and external distribution.

Central Park Group LLC - Freelance Graphic Designer and Video Producer

March 2011 - September 2012, New York NY

- Worked directly with the head of marketing, creating layouts and designs for print and web marketing material, directing and shooting video on location with fund managers, and in turn editing video for web and mobile marketing purposes.